



# Market Briefs **Pro**

*Read less news*

**Hey, Pro Briefers!**

And welcome to Part II of our special report.

This week, we're finishing up our report the Broad Market Shift: U.S. investors are increasingly looking to foreign markets for stability and long-term growth

- The Bureau of Economic Analysis reported Americans invested hundreds of billions in foreign companies in Q1 of 2025, an all-time high.

**Why is money leaving?** Between an uncertain political climate, and foreign markets looking to become more independent, the U.S. economy has become more volatile.

And investors aren't happy about it.

Even with the U.S. economy showing more growth than many other countries, investors have been looking for other markets that may be more reliable.

That's why last week, we looked at the European markets.

Europe is increasingly being viewed as a stable economy, showing slower, but steady growth.

**Our team traveled to Europe**, and what they found is that some of the biggest European companies are growing much faster than their American counterparts - even during downturns.

But what about investors looking for high growth? The amount of capital leaving U.S. markets accounts for more than just those looking for stability.

# Region Rankings 2024

| <i>Name</i>                          | <i>GDP Growth Rate</i> |
|--------------------------------------|------------------------|
| <b>South Asia</b>                    | <b>6.353%</b>          |
| <b>East Asia &amp; Pacific</b>       | <b>4.095%</b>          |
| <b>Sub-Saharan Africa</b>            | <b>2.955%</b>          |
| <b>World</b>                         | <b>2.719%</b>          |
| <b>North America</b>                 | <b>2.43%</b>           |
| <b>Latin America &amp; Caribbean</b> | <b>2.153%</b>          |
| <b>OECD Members</b>                  | <b>1.667%</b>          |
| <b>European Union</b>                | <b>0.451%</b>          |
| <b>Euro Area</b>                     | <b>0.447%</b>          |

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Data [via](#) Our World in Data

Investors looking for fast growth have been increasingly looking to Asia-Pacific.

- While not as stable, the Asia-Pacific region has shown the highest growth rates in the world for several years.

So this week we'll be diving into some of the hottest regions in Asia-Pacific, taking a look at some of their fastest-growing companies, and ETFs that represent these economies.

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**Have some feedback?** Let us know your thoughts on this Shift by responding directly to this email!

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**JAPAN**

**A Brand New Nikkei**

Japanese markets and their largest index, the Nikkei 225 have been a longtime favorite of investors looking to diversify their portfolios.

After restructuring for greater transparency in 2022, the Tokyo Stock Exchange has made it easy for investors to know exactly what they're buying.

Separating stocks into one of three categories:

- Prime (Large, globally competitive companies)
- Standard (Stable, mid-sized businesses)
- Growth (Start-ups and small-cap companies)

This easy classification helped the Nikkei ended 2024 with historic highs, beating analyst expectations by a large margin:



Data via Yahoo! Finance

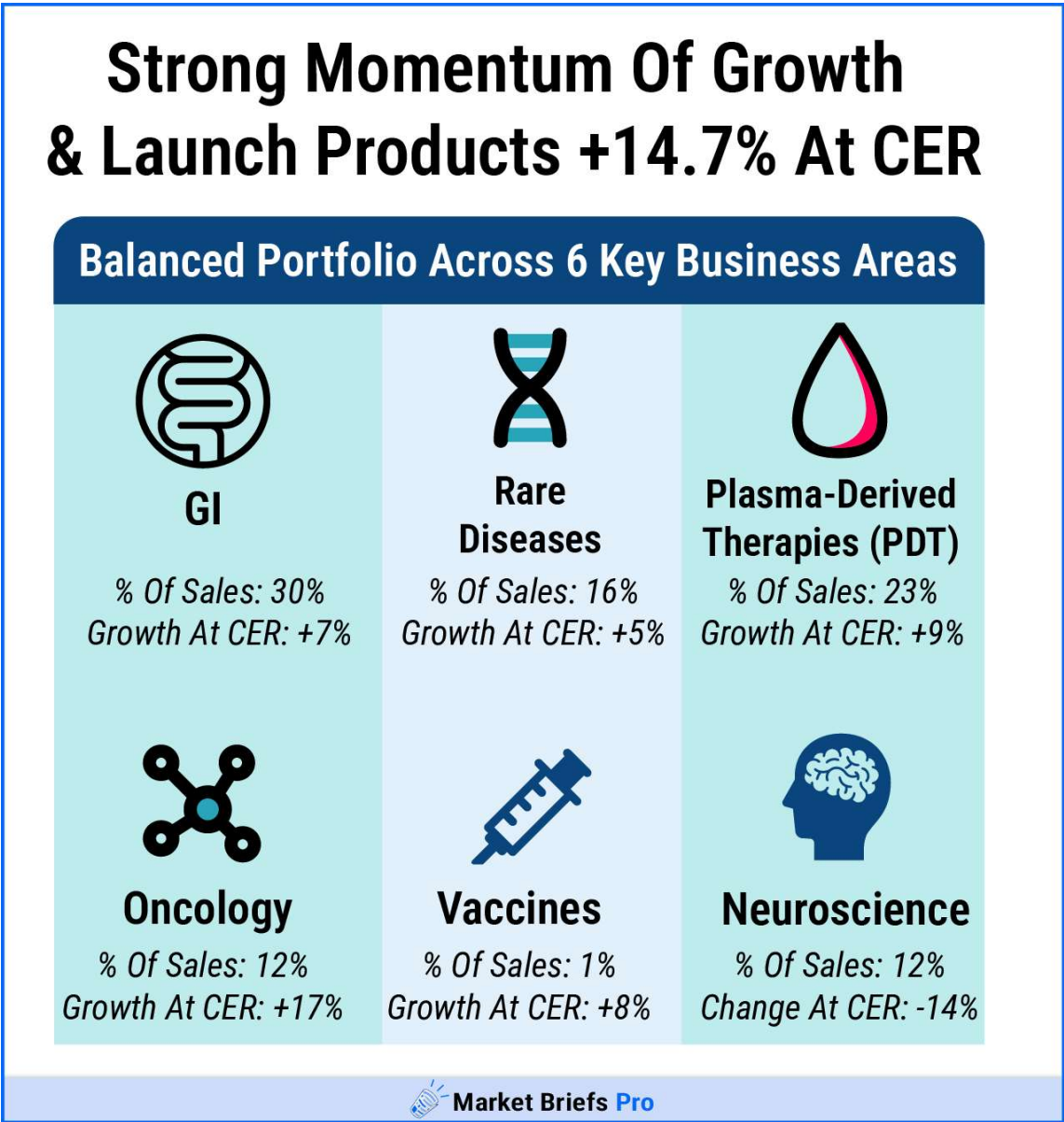
- The Nikkei 225 grew 19.2% in 2024, its growth outpacing analyst expectations as early as February.

Although the Nikkei has struggled alongside American markets in 2025, down 6.9% YTD, it's still ahead of long-term expectations.

It should come as no surprise that some of Japan's staples are far outpacing their American counterparts.

The strength and steady growth of the Japanese economy is very apparent when looking at the pharmaceutical industry, and the Japanese giant, Takeda (TAK).

Specializing in vaccine and cancer treatments, Takeda is the largest pharma company in Japan and is considered one of the Japanese economy's foundational corporations.



Data [via](#) Company Reports

Takeda grew alongside the Japanese markets in 2024, increasing revenue by 7.45% to \$30.5 billion.

And while 2025 projections had it remaining flat, so far, it has beaten expectations.

- In Q1 of 2025, Takeda's revenue was \$7.75 billion, beating projections by \$410 million.
- Q1 EPS was \$0.56, beating the \$0.37 estimate by more than 51%.

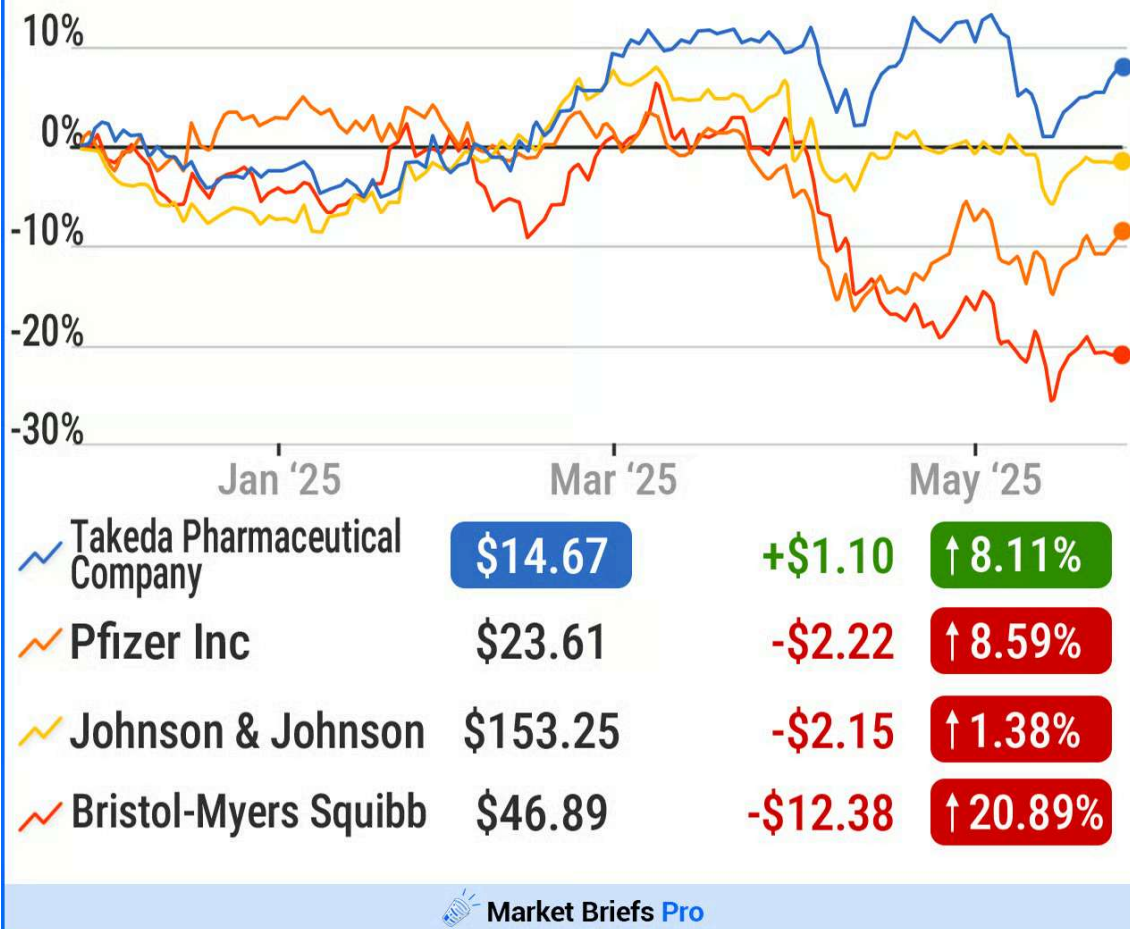
But Takeda's strength is most apparent when compared to its American competitors.

Takeda's major competitors include American pharma giants Pfizer (PFE), Johnson & Johnson (JNJ), and Bristol-Myers Squibb (BMY).

When comparing these companies YTD, only Takeda and Johnson & Johnson are in the green:

- Takeda is up 10% YTD.
- Pfizer is down 11% YTD.
- Johnson & Johnson is up 5.9% YTD.
- Bristol-Myers Squibb is down 17% YTD.

# Takeda Pharmaceutical Company 6-Month Share Price vs. Competitors



Data via Google Finance

- In the past 6 months, Takeda is up 8%, while its competitors are all in the red.

The global pharmaceutical industry is facing a number of challenges, including regulatory complexity, rising R&D costs, and public pressure on pricing and accessibility.

Takeda's growth in the face of these issues shows that while investors are losing confidence in the U.S. markets, they still have faith in Japan.

Investors looking for a growth-oriented Japanese ETF can find it in the iShares MSCI Japan Small-Cap ETF (SCJ), which focuses on stocks classified as "Growth" by the exchange.



# iShares MSCI Japan Small-Cap ETF (SCJ)

YTD Year Price →

**83.46**  
**(+14.09%)**



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Data [via](#) Google Finance

## INDIA

### India's Impressive Growth

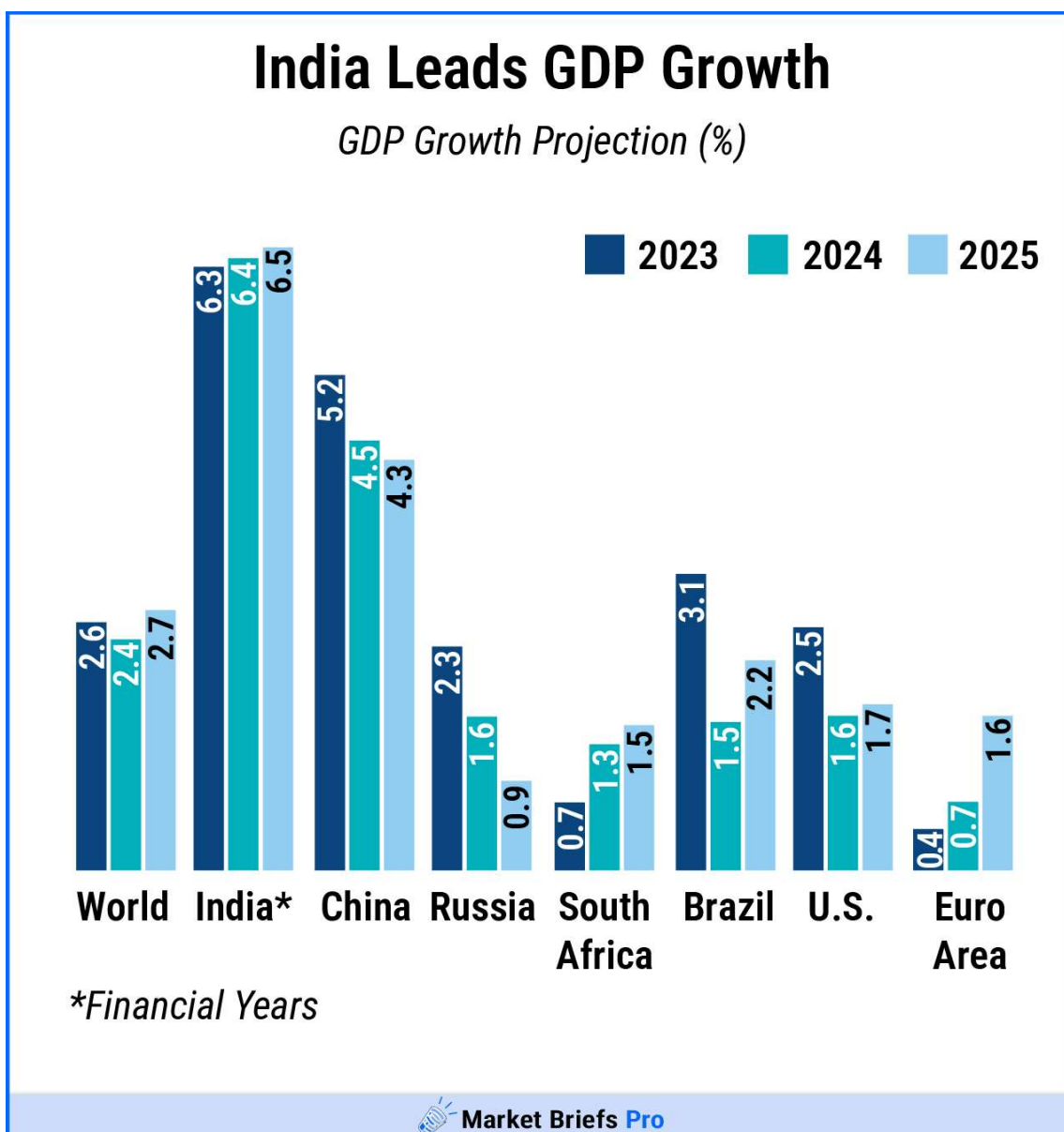
The Japanese markets are impressive, but still relatively safe. Those looking for a bit more risk and reward have been looking to India.

- India recently overtook Japan as the 4th largest economy in the world with a GDP of \$4.19 trillion.

The country is projecting a GDP growth of 6.4% in fiscal year 2024-25, following a growth of 8.2% in 2023-24.

- In the same period, the U.S. GDP grew 2.8%

**What does that mean?** India is one of the largest and fastest-growing economies in the world.



Data [via](#) Times of India

U.S. markets have limited exposure to India's economy, but a company from one of India's most formidable industries trades on the NYSE.

ICICI Bank (IBN) is India's second-largest bank by market cap, and has shown stronger growth than both its direct competitors in India and the major U.S. banks.

**Banking Metrics:** ICICI Bank's latest reports show strong growth in several areas that are specifically used to measure the growth of a bank:

- Net profit is up 15.5% YoY
- Net Interest Income is up 11% YoY



- Loan growth is up 15% YoY

## ICICI Bank Interest Income 2024

|                                            | FY2024  | Q4-2024 | Q3-2025   | Q4-2025 | FY2025  |
|--------------------------------------------|---------|---------|-----------|---------|---------|
|                                            | Audited | Audited | Unaudited | Audited | Audited |
| <b>Net Interest Income</b>                 | 74,306  | 19,093  | 20,371    | 21,193  | 81,165  |
| <b>Non-Interest Income</b>                 | 22,949  | 5,930   | 6,697     | 7,021   | 26,603  |
| – <i>Fee Income</i>                        | 20,796  | 5,436   | 6,180     | 6,306   | 23,870  |
| – <i>Dividend Income From Subsidiaries</i> | 2,073   | 484     | 509       | 675     | 2,619   |
| – <i>Other Income</i>                      | 80      | 10      | 8         | 40      | 114     |
| <b>Less:</b>                               |         |         |           |         |         |
| <b>Operating Expense</b>                   | 39,133  | 9,703   | 10,552    | 10,789  | 42,372  |

 **Market Briefs Pro**

Data [via](#) Company Reports

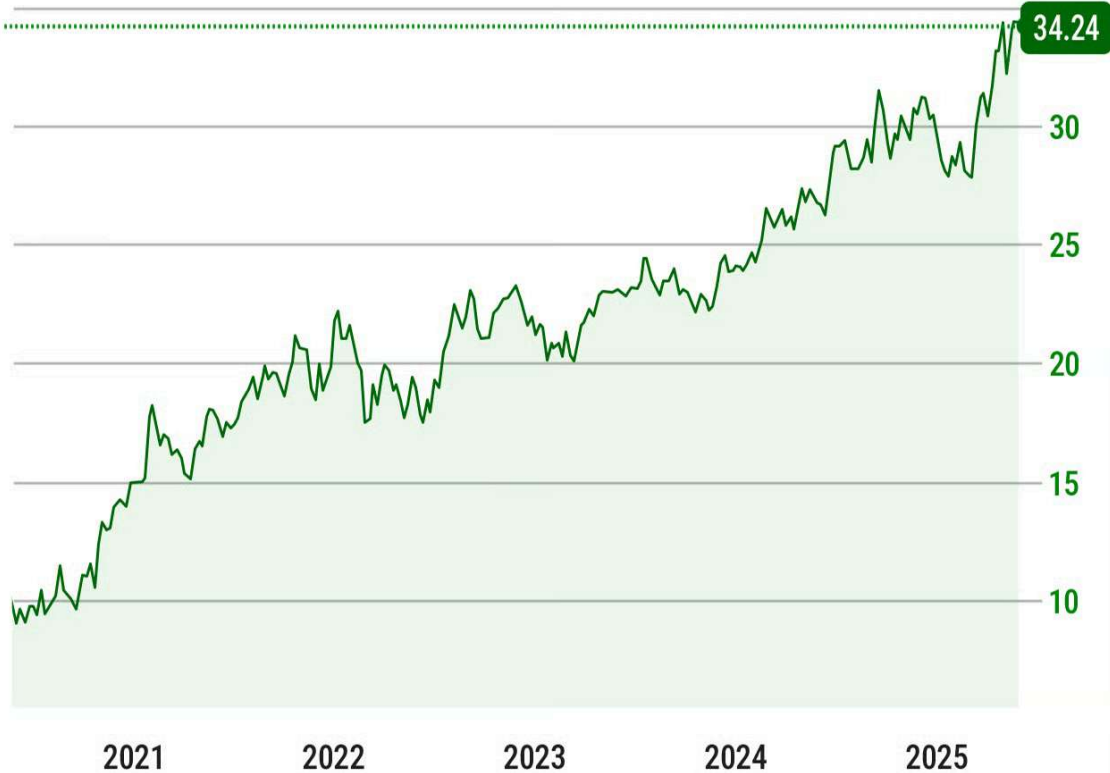
Being one of the oldest and largest banks in India, ICICI Bank shows natural growth alongside the economy as a whole.

**What does this mean?** ICICI Bank is showing every indicator of a bank on the rise, and its share price reflects this.

# ICICI Bank Limited (IBN)

5 Year Price →

**34.24**  
**(+334.30%)**



 **Market Briefs Pro**

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

- ICICI Bank's shares are up 334% over the last 5 years.

This growth outpaces major U.S. banks, even on the U.S. exchanges.

- JPMorgan Chase (JPM) is up about 161% over the last 5 years.

Banking as a whole is seeing record profits, so in a sense, ICICI Bank is outpacing the American giants at their best.

# ICICI Bank Ltd

## YTD Share Price vs. Competitors



|                             |          |          |         |
|-----------------------------|----------|----------|---------|
| ICICI Bank Ltd              | \$34.31  | +\$4.45  | ↑14.90% |
| JPMorgan Chase & Co         | \$265.29 | +\$25.58 | ↑10.67% |
| Bank Of America Corporation | \$44.22  | +\$0.27  | ↑ 0.61% |

Market Briefs Pro

Data via Google Finance

**And not just in the long-term,** ICICI Bank is outpacing JPMorgan, Bank of America, Wells Fargo, and Citigroup YTD as well.

With the U.S. dollar being threatened as the global reserve currency, and India continuing to undergo rapid growth, it seems as though ICICI Bank is just getting started.

Currently, India is showing the strongest GDP growth of any developed nation, so investors looking for growth will still find it in their mid and large-cap companies.

These can be found in the iShares MSCI India ETF (INDA).

- Up 2.6% YTD, this ETF shows large swings that are more common in high-growth sectors.

# iShares MSCI India ETF (INDA)

YTD Year Price →

**54.01**  
**(+2.61%)**



 **Market Briefs Pro**

Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

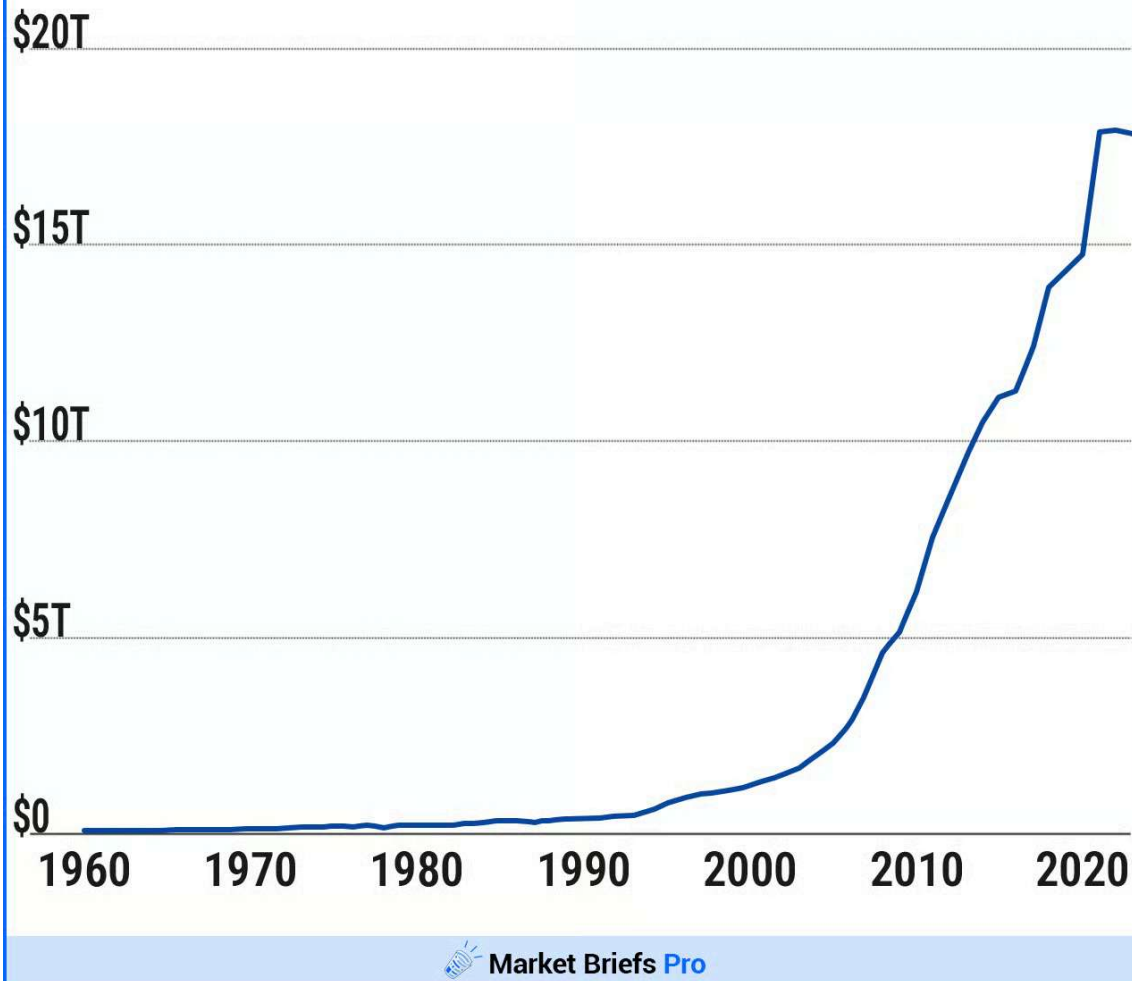
## CHINA

### All Roads Lead to China

While India might have the strongest GDP growth right now, when looking at long-term growth rates, Asia-Pacific and the world have been dominated by China.

Over the last 30 years, China has transformed itself from a relatively small market into the second-largest economy in the world (by quite a large margin).

# China's Global Nominal GDP Growth In USD (1960–2023)



Data [via](#) World Bank

**Then:** In 1990, China's GDP was \$361 billion.

**Now:** in 2023, China's GDP was \$17.8 trillion

Although it has slowed down, China still has the second-highest GDP growth rate, even with increasingly strict trade policy from the U.S. and EU.

**What drives China's growth?** One of the biggest growth factors is China's massive consumer base, which drives powerful consumer industries, like packaged goods and hospitality.

China plays a significant role in shaping consumer brands around the world, which is why many global brands have chosen to spin off their Chinese operations.

This includes China's largest restaurant company by both number of stores and presence, Yum Brands China (YUMC).



# YumChina's Brands



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Data [via](#) YumChina

- Originally spun off from American giant Yum! Brands, Yum China manages brands like KFC, Taco Bell, Lavazza, and a number of local holdings.

With over 12,000 locations spread across 1,100 cities, Yum China is the country's largest employer in the private sector, creating more than 450,000 jobs.

The company has also put a great deal of money towards differentiating itself from Yum! Brands, through PR maneuvers and brand diversity.

Through much of 2024, China was widely considered to be in an economic crisis, and 2025 started with a trade war between China and the U.S. (one that is still ongoing.)

But that doesn't seem to have slowed Yum China's growth:



- The company opened 247 new stores in Q1 2025, with plans to open 1,800 stores by the end of the year.
- It announced an additional \$510 million in share buybacks throughout 2025, adding to its existing \$360 million buyback plan.

Yum China remains optimistic about 2025, but its share prices have struggled, down more than 9% YTD.



Data via Yahoo! Finance

However, the brand is still up 22% over the past year.

China's economy faces a number of challenges, both internally and abroad.

In addition to an ongoing trade war with the United States, many other countries have been trying to stop Chinese brands from going global.

**How?** Tariffs and other trade regulations.

- The EU announced up to 37% tariffs on Chinese EVs in July 2024.

Shifting global regulations often subject the Chinese markets to a high level of volatility, but in the long term, the Chinese market is still showing incredible growth.

Yum China is a major pillar of the Chinese economy, and seems likely to keep growing alongside the nation's economy.

Investors looking for broad exposure to China's powerful consumer sector can find many of its staples (including Yum China) in the Global X MSCI China Consumer Discretionary ETF (CHIQ).

- Featuring Chinese consumer staples has allowed this fund to be up nearly 12% YTD despite turmoil in the market.



Data [via](#) Yahoo! Finance

### The Problem With Growth Stocks

Much like companies on the major European markets, those in Asia-Pacific are greatly affected by U.S. markets and policy.

China, in particular, is constantly at odds with other nations, and very often sees market swings from political tension.

And once again, these stocks we've discussed are being traded in U.S. markets, using the U.S. dollar.

So U.S. investor sentiment and a weakening dollar can still have an effect on them.

Japan is a close U.S. ally, and finding news on Japanese markets is about as common as finding news about Europe, but news regarding Indian and Chinese companies can be extremely difficult to track down.

Finally, trading in growth economies poses the same risks as trading in growth stocks - they're more susceptible to major swings both up **and down**.

While many of these companies have performed well over a long period of time, a quick look at their share history will show a higher level of volatility.

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## REVIEW

### ...And Beyond

Asia-Pacific continues to attract investors looking for high growth, and Europe continues to provide a level of stability, but...

#### What about the U.S.?

The U.S.'s position in the global economy is certainly shifting, but it still has the strongest economy in the world - and that is unlikely to change.

While China may eventually overtake the United States in GDP, the U.S. market will have better global exposure.

**But isn't money leaving U.S. markets?** It is - at an increasing rate.

We're all still figuring out the global economy, and participating on that international scale is becoming more important every year.

We've talked about some of the highlights, but there's other countries, both in these regions, and beyond that are also seeing major growth.

- Brazil, with the world's second-largest oil industry, and the UAE, with its massive tech investments, are noteworthy markets.

Investors looking to build a portfolio that capitalizes on the growing global economy can use this report as a starting point as they continue to explore markets abroad.

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